Cole Smith

Austin, Texas 78722 | 512-567-2933 | cas8698@my.utexas.edu | github.com/csmith454

EDUCATION

The University of Texas at Austin
M.A., Russian, East European, and Eurasian Studies, *GPA: 3.95* May 2027
- Thesis: Forthcoming, "Whack-a-mole: The Shadow Fleet and Sanctions on Russia"

B.A., International Relations and Global Studies, *GPA: 3.96* May 2024
- Capstone: "A Thawed Conflict: the Impact of Arctic Shipping on Sámi and Iñupiaq Peoples"

CERTIFICATIONS

Fundamentals for Teaching Assistants December 2026
Center for Teaching and Learning at the University of Texas at Austin
Elements of Computing December 2024
Department of Computer Science at the University of Texas at Austin

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Money, Politics, Corruption, *Teaching Assistant* August 2026 - Present
- Led 3 weekly discussion sections for 50+ students, navigating extensive study of political and economic institutions
- Organized 2 on-campus excursions for students to apply knowledge of course concepts to local resources

The Hidden Lives of Maps, *Teaching Assistant* January 2026 - May 2026
- Led 3 weekly discussions sections for 50+ students, guiding them through complex cartographic theory and application
- Mentored students in and outside of weekly office hours to provide constructive feedback, career advice, and helpful resources

Seekers and Mystics, *Teaching Assistant* August 2025 - December 2025
- Led 2 weekly discussions sections for 40+ students, facilitating understanding of difficult historical and religious texts
- Held 2+ office hours per week to engage with students one-on-one

Guest Lectures

"Data Analysis for Russian, Eastern European, and Eurasian Studies" September 2026

"Shamanism in Russia" November 2025

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

"Russian Arteries of Influence," *Graduate Research Assistant* January 2026 - present
- Synthesized more than 20 publications related to Russian energy and European dependence
- Crafted 3 original datasets detailing Bulgarian government and energy history using techniques such as webscraping, PDF parsing, and clear database organization

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- Utilized original data analysis to contribute to Dr. Mary Neuburger's complication of stories of European energy dependence and Russia's 'energy weapon'
- Presented at the Energy & Power in Russia, Eastern Europe and Eurasia Symposium at the University of Texas at Austin, April 10th, 2026

"How Elite Beliefs Change During a Defection Cascade" September 2025 - February 2026

- Conducted original data analysis on more than 12,000 answers from the ICPSR Survey of Russian Elites, Moscow, Russia, 1993-2020
- Integrated more than 10 publications on the ICPSR Survey with study of Elite Theory, utilizing Michael Burton and John Higley's scholarship
- Presented at the poster session for the Eurasia Policy Symposium at the AT&T Conference Center on February 12th, 2026

PUBLICATIONS

Neuburger, Mary C. Evan Samsky & Cole A. Smith (Forthcoming) "Russian Arteries of Influence" in *Contemporary Russia in World History: A Hinge Nation in a Multipolar World?* edited by Choi Chatterjee and Karen Petrone. OUP.

AWARDS

Professional Development Award from CREEES April 2026

- $1,250 to purchase data for Master's thesis

Truitt Fellowship Award August 2025

- $1,500 for study of Russia, Eastern Europe, and Eurasia

LANGUAGES

Russian

- Reading: Can read with dictionary
- Writing: Conversational
- Speaking: Conversational

Spanish

- Reading: Proficient
- Writing: Proficient
- Speaking: Proficient